# Child interview and suitability record: Years 1 and 2

| | |
|---|---|
| **Child's name** | |
| **Year group applied for** | |
| **Date** | |
| **Interviewer** | |
| **Others present (for example receiving homeroom teacher; Chinese-speaking colleague)** | |

**About 6 minutes, 1:1, play-based.** Most of what you need about a 5 or 6 year old comes from watching them during the whole visit, not from questions. This short chat, at the end of the visit, is **in English**. It has three jobs: to hear the child's spoken English, to get to know the child (likes, family, friends, **what they want to be**), and to judge their readiness for the international programme. Use the observation boxes in Section 4 for the whole visit.

**How to do it.** Sit on the floor or at a low table beside the child. Offer paper and crayons: "Can you draw you, doing something you love?" Talk about the drawing. Ask the main question first; if the child does not answer, use the **easier** prompt (a choice, a yes or no, or "show me"). Wait. Praise effort. Never press a child who is upset; stop and let them go back to their parent. If a Chinese-speaking colleague is present, they may ask one or two questions in Chinese at the end so that you learn about the child: mark them "C"; they do not count towards the speaking band.

**Safeguarding.** A young child is never alone with one adult behind a closed door. If a child says something that worries you, write down their words and pass it to the Designated Safeguarding Lead the same day.

## 1. Questions

| Topic | Main question | Easier | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Me** | What is your name? How old are you? | Show me with your fingers. | |
| | Tell me about your picture. | Is this you? What are you doing? | |
| **Family** | Who lives at your home? | Do you have a brother? A sister? A pet? | |
| **Likes** | What do you like to play? | Do you like to run? Draw? Play with blocks? | |
| | What is your favourite food? Favourite animal? | Do you like noodles? Do you like cats? | |
| **School** | Tell me about your school (or kindergarten). | Do you like it? What do you do there? | |
| | Who are your friends? | Do you play with friends? | |
| **Feelings** | What makes you happy? | Are you happy today? (point to a happy or sad face) | |
| **When I grow up** | What do you want to be when you grow up? | A teacher? A doctor? A footballer? | |
| **Here** | Would you like to come to this school? What would you like to do here? | Do you want to play here? Learn English here? | |

## 2. Speaking band

Circle the band that fits best, for a child of this age.

| Band | What you hear |
|---|---|
| **A** New to English | No English yet, or one or two words. Uses Chinese, pointing or silence. May copy a word you say. |
| **B** Early acquisition | Single words and short phrases ("cat", "my mummy", "I like red"). Understands simple questions with gesture or pictures. |
| **C** Developing competence | Short sentences about familiar things ("I play with my friend"), with errors. Understands most simple questions. |
| **D** Competent | Talks in sentences, tells you about the picture or a simple event, joins ideas with "and" or "because". |
| **E** Fluent | Talks as a fluent English-speaking child of 5 or 6 would. |

Speaking band: **A** **B** **C** **D** **E** Listening in conversation: **A** **B** **C** **D** **E**

## 3. Observations during the whole visit

Tick what you saw, and add a note.

| What to look for | Seen | Notes |
|---|---|---|
| Separates from the parent without great distress, or settles within a few minutes | ☐ | |
| Joins in the activities and stays with each one for a few minutes | ☐ | |
| Follows a simple instruction (with gesture if needed) | ☐ | |
| Holds a pencil or crayon with control; draws a person with several parts | ☐ | |
| Takes turns, shares, waits | ☐ | |
| Shows curiosity: looks, touches, asks, explores | ☐ | |
| Copies new English words, or tries to | ☐ | |
| Recovers when something is hard or when they do not understand | ☐ | |
| Uses the toilet, coat and shoes independently (ask the parent) | ☐ | |

## 4. Readiness

Rate each strand. **1** Concern, **2** Some concern, **3** Good, **4** Strong. Write the evidence.

| Strand | What strong looks like at this age | Rating | Evidence |
|---|---|---|---|
| Attitude to learning | Enjoys the activities, has a go, pleased with success | ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4 | |
| Curiosity and engagement | Interested, explores, asks questions | ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4 | |
| Social and emotional readiness | Settles with new adults, manages separation, plays alongside or with others | ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4 | |
| Independence | Manages simple tasks and self-care for age | ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4 | |
| Kindness and conduct | Gentle, polite, shares | ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4 | |
| Readiness for learning in English | Happy in an English-speaking setting, tries words, is not distressed by not understanding | ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4 | |

## 5. Anything to follow up

| Area | Tick | Notes |
|---|---|---|
| Speech and language (for example very little speech in Chinese as well as English, unclear speech for age) | ☐ | |
| Attention, hearing, vision, movement or fine motor skills | ☐ | |
| Wellbeing (for example very anxious, very tired) | ☐ | |
| Safeguarding (passed to the Designated Safeguarding Lead the same day) | ☐ | |
| Medical or dietary | ☐ | |

**Speech in Chinese.** If a Chinese-speaking colleague is present, ask them to note how the child speaks in Chinese. A child with little English but age-appropriate Chinese is a typical English learner. A child who also has very little speech in Chinese for their age may need a speech and language check: raise it with the parent gently, as a question rather than a conclusion.

## 6. Receiving homeroom teacher (optional)

First impressions and what the child would need in the first weeks (for example a buddy, picture cards for routines, a familiar comfort object, a gradual start).

**Interviewer signature and date** _____